

Shaping

Exercise no. 5

On Franz Schubert's *Ave Maria* (*Ellens dritter Gesang*, D 839) (1825) — public domain.

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What you will do: in Exercise no. 4 you cleaned up the *Ave Maria* and played it over the piano. The accompaniment is correct, but it sounds **flat**: every note exactly on the grid, like a machine. Here you give it shape — the right-hand triplets heard as groups, each group **breathing**, and the tempo settling at the end of the verse —. Then you record yourself again.

How long: about thirty minutes. **What you need:** the file `Ejercicio-5_Ave_Maria.mmf` (the finished score from Exercise no. 4), the **COSMIC KEYBOARD** open for sound, and Exercise no. 4 done.

If something goes wrong: the **UNDO** button on the top bar undoes the last step, and you can press it several times in a row. Try things without fear.

Five words you will meet

Triplet	three notes in the time of two. The piano's right hand plays two triplets per beat , each one starting after a rest.
Intelligent Beams	the Score reads how the notes are grouped under one beam and plays them as a group, with strong and weak notes. The Level says how much it shows.
Agogics	the small pushes and holds that make music breathe. Nobody plays with a metronome; agogics is what the metronome lacks.
ASYM AGOG region	a golden band over a stretch of one channel. Inside it the notes move earlier or later along a curve. With Move , the stretch pushes forward toward the middle and comes back to the grid at the end: the group leans ahead and settles.
Pattern	a region with a name . Named, it can be taken to other bars in one go (Take) and hidden or deleted all together.

PART ONE — THE TRIPLETS

IN THE PICTURES: the orange circles show where to look or click.

1 • Open the file and listen to the piano alone

Open the SCORE (from the COSMIC KEYBOARD) and in **MENU FILES** → **IMPORT MMF** load **Ejercicio-5_Ave_Maria.mmf**. Open the **CONSOLE** too and press **M** on the clarinet channel, as in Exercise no. 4: now you will work on the piano.

Listen to the first verse. Watch the right hand (**CH2 • RH**): the chords all go the same, one after the other, with no direction.

2 • Intelligent Beams: the triplets as groups

1. Right-click the **3·2** button on the top bar (next to **R·K**): the **INTELLIGENT BEAMS** window opens.
2. In **Range**: **M 1** → **M 31** — the whole verse and the interlude.
3. In **CH**: the channel you had active comes on. Turn it off and turn on only **2**: the right hand.
4. In **Level**: **3**.
5. Close the window with its **⊗**.

Check: at the bottom of the window you read «✓ **Level 3 • M1–M31 • CH 2 • 620 notes**». Listen: the first note of each triplet leans and the other two follow. They are no longer loose chords, they are groups.

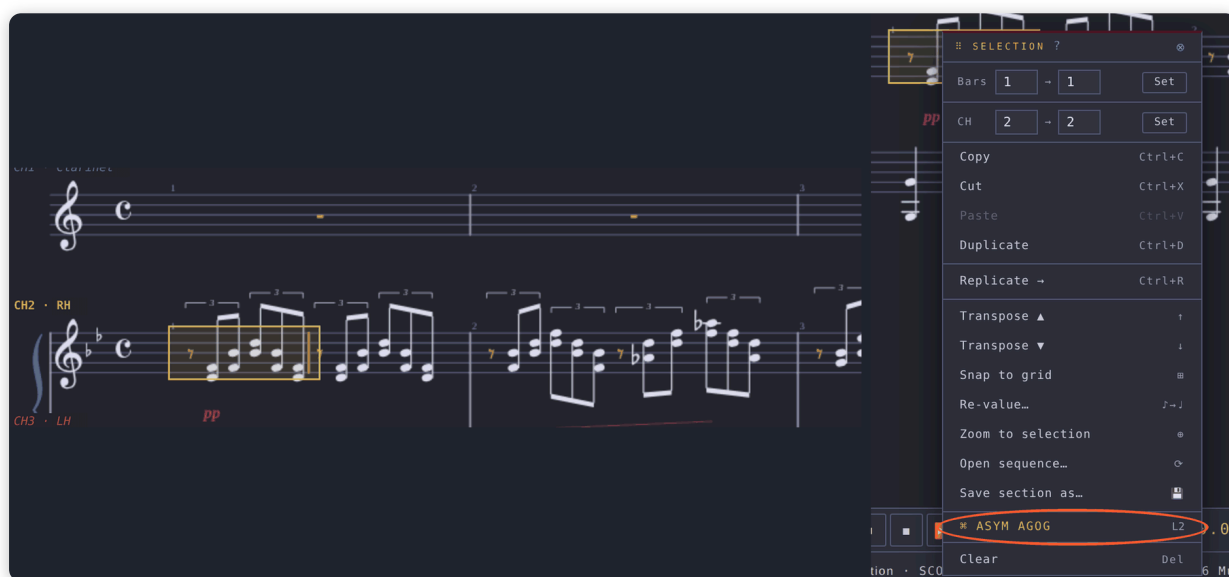


3 • An ASYM AGOG region in bar 1

Now that the triplets sound grouped, give them motion. Start with the first two beats of bar 1.

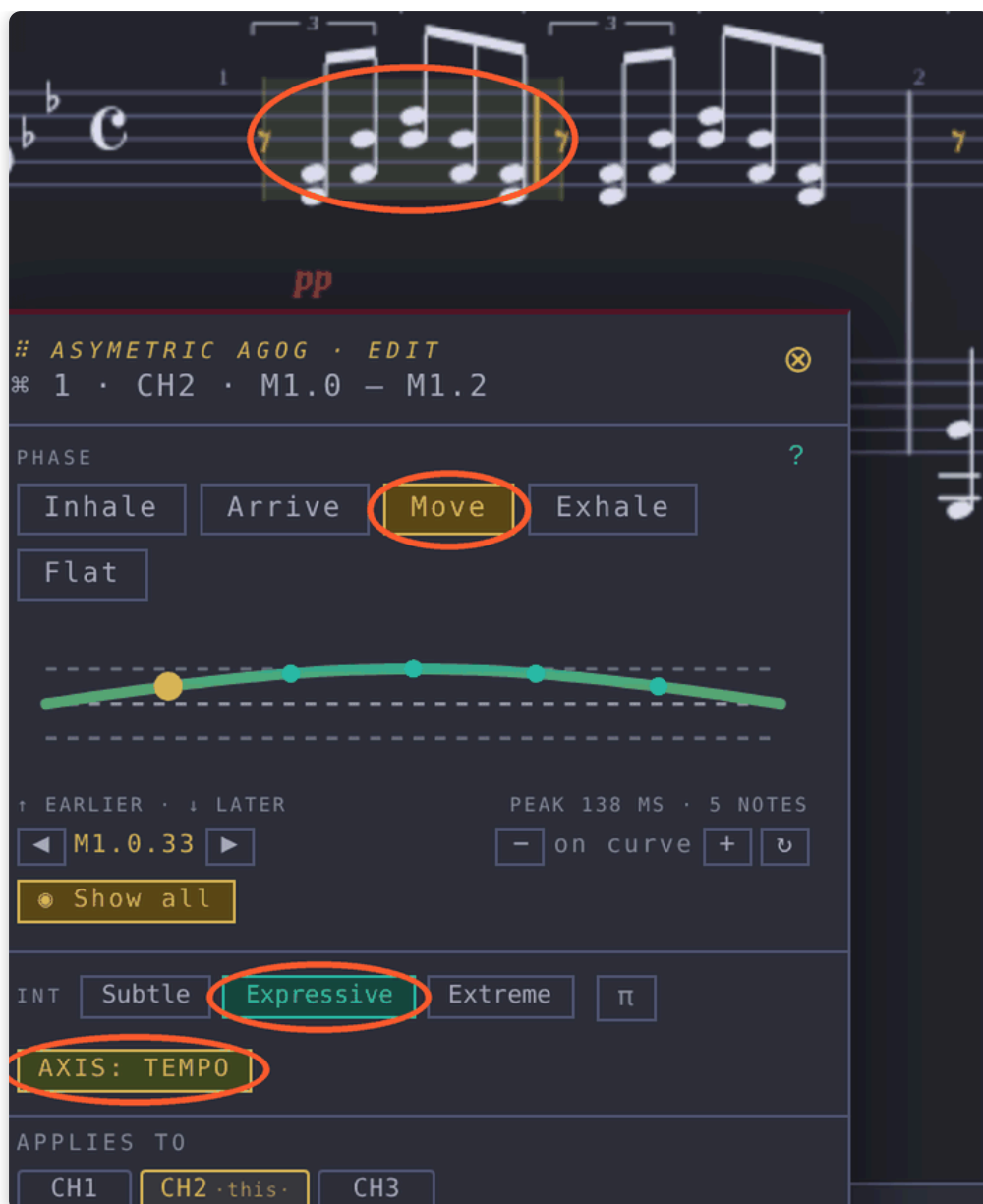
1. Press **SELECT** (it turns **■**) and leave **CURSOR • CH**.
2. In the right hand (**CH2**), drag from the start of bar 1 to the end of beat 2. **Start the drag above the notes**, at the height of the top staff line.
3. Right-click **inside the region, just above the top staff line**, where there are no notes: the **SELECTION** menu opens.
4. At the bottom of the menu, **ASYM AGOG**.

If you drag from a note, you move it. In SELECT, starting the drag on a notehead **moves** it instead of selecting. If that happens, UNDO and start again higher up. And as in Exercise no. 4: right-clicking a note opens its editor, not the SELECTION menu.



The **ASYMETRIC AGOG** editor opens and a golden band appears on the score.

5. **PHASE:** **Move**.
6. **INT** (intensity): **Expressive**.
7. Check that the axis reads **AXIS: TEMPO** — the region moves time, not volume.
8. Close the editor with its **⊗** and press **Esc** to leave SELECT.

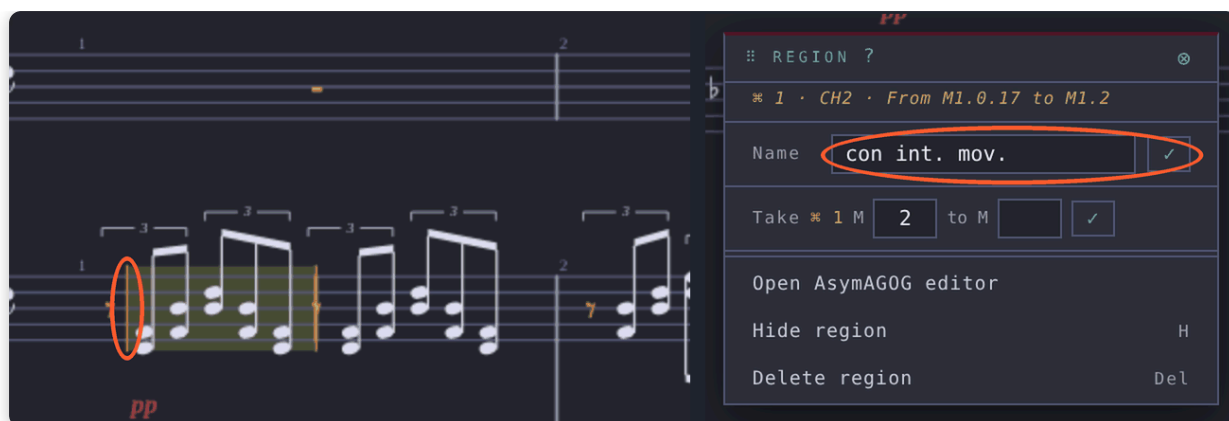


4 • Fit the band and name it

The band has to start **after the rest** at the beginning of the bar — the rest does not move — and end at the end of beat 2.

1. Bring the mouse to the band's **left edge** (the thin line) until the cursor turns into $\leftrightarrow$, and drag it to just after the rest. The edge snaps in small steps.
2. If the right edge is not at the end of beat 2, drag it the same way.
3. Right-click the band's **right edge**, just above the top staff line: the **REGION** menu opens.
4. In **Name** type **con int. mov.** ("with inner motion") and press ☒.

Check: the REGION menu title reads **From M1.0.17 to M1.2** — the stretch starts a little after beat 1 (after the rest) and ends with beat 2. Listen to bar 1: the first two triplets push forward and settle on the second one.



5 • The second band: beats 3 and 4

The same for the other half of bar 1:

1. ☐ SELECT and drag over CH2 from **beat 3** to the end of the bar, above the notes.
2. Right-click above the top line, inside the region → ☐ ASYM AGOG.
3. Move · Expressive, close the editor and Esc.
4. Drag the left edge to **after the rest of beat 3**.
5. Right-click its right edge → **Name**: the same name, **con int. mov.** (the field offers it in its list) → ☒.

Check: bar 1 has two bands, each starting after its rest. The second one reads **From M1.2.17 to M1.4**.

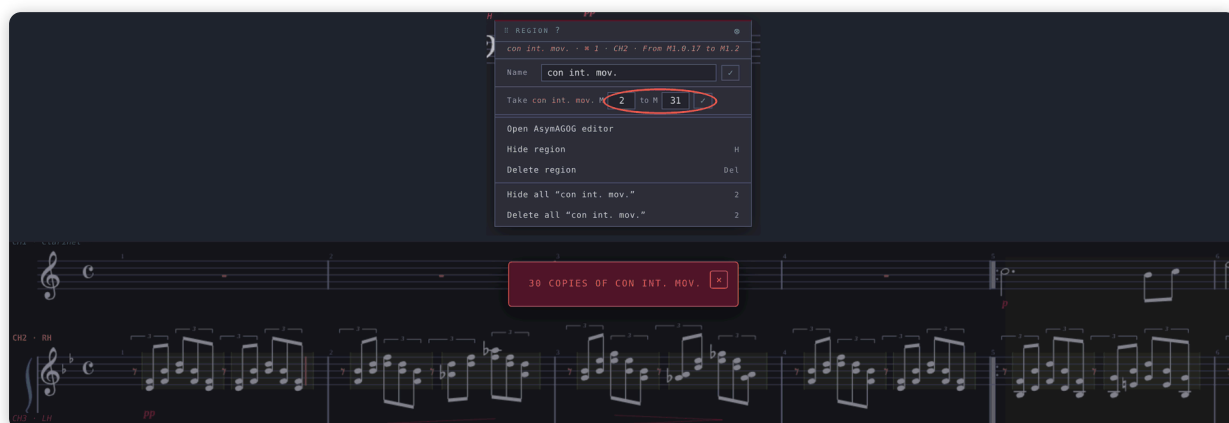


6 • Take it through the whole verse

No need to do it 31 times: both bands have a name, so they are a **pattern**.

1. Right-click the edge of the **first** band → REGION menu.
2. In the **Take** row: M 2 to M 31 and ☒.
3. The Score reports «**30 copies of con int. mov.**». Close the notice with its x.
4. Repeat with the **second** band: Take M 2 to M 31 ✓.

Check: every bar from 1 to 31 has its two bands. In the REGION menu, the row **Hide all “con int. mov.”** counts **62**.

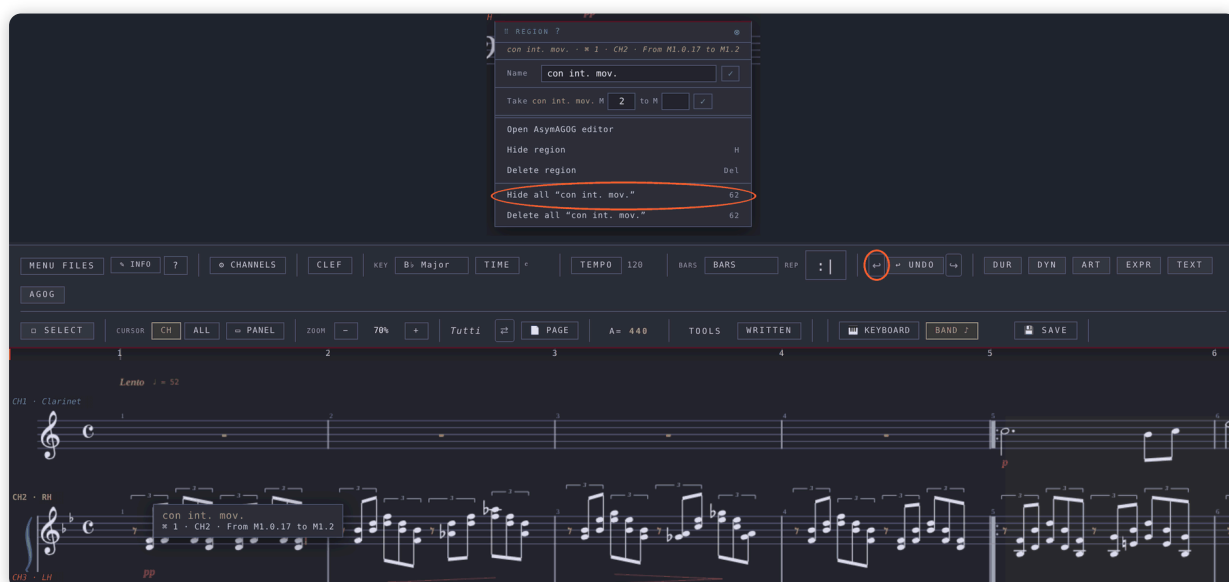


7 • Listen and compare

Listen to the whole verse. Then compare it with the unshaped piano:

1. Right-click the edge of any band → **Hide all “con int. mov.”**.
2. The bands disappear and the piano sounds flat again. Listen to the same bars.
3. Press **↶** (UNDO) and the 62 bands come back.

Hidden does not play. A hidden region does not move time, and it cannot be reached with a right-click either. To bring it back without undoing: put the yellow cursor inside its span and press **Alt+H** — the REGION menu opens with **Show region** and **Show all**. To remove the pattern for good, the same menu has **Delete all “con int. mov.”**.



PART TWO — THE TEMPO

8 • The tempo, last

With the shape in place, the file's ♩ = 52 feels heavy. You will set three markings: the tempo of the piece, and two that are not printed — they are there for the sound — at the end of the verse.

Where	BPM	Term	Scope	Shown
bar 1	60	Lento	This bar	Show
bar 28, first right-hand note	62	—	This place	Hide
bar 29, halfway through beat 3	54	—	This place	Hide

For each one:

1. **Put the yellow cursor on the spot.** Click the staff at that point. For bar 28, click the first right-hand chord (after the rest). For bar 29, click above the right-hand notes, between the second and third chords of beat 3.
2. **TEMPO** button: the TEMPO window opens.
3. Type the **BPM** first. The Score suggests a term; if the marking has one (the *Lento* of bar 1), type it **afterwards** in **Term**.
4. **Scope:** **This bar** for bar 1; **This place** for the other two — the marking goes at the cursor's exact point.
5. The **Show** / **Hide** switch: Show for bar 1, Hide for the other two.
6. The bottom button: **Toggle / Update Marking** in bar 1 (there already was a *Lento* there, and it changes it) or **Insert Marking** for the new ones.

Check: above bar 1 it reads **Lento ♩ = 60**. The other two are not printed; with **SHOW HIDDEN** on in the TEMPO window they show faintly (♩ = 62 and ♩ = 54). Listen from bar 27 to 30: a little more life as the verse ends, and a breath that slows before starting again.

When you set a tempo marking other than the first one, the coach 🎓 may explain how a new tempo settles. Read it and close it with its ×.



Save it: **MENU FILES** → **EXPORT MMF** .

9 • Record yourself again

Record as in step 11 of Exercise no. 4: the clarinet on **M**, your MIC channel set, and **● REC** in the Console.

Then listen to both recordings, the one from Exercise no. 4 and this one. Did the way you play change over a piano that breathes? Where do you let yourself be carried, and where do you have to wait for it?

► Want to compare with a finished version?

Congratulations: the accompaniment is no longer a machine

Try other shapes in bar 1 — **Inhale, Arrive**, another intensity — and hear how the character changes.
UNDO always takes you back to *con int. mov.*